



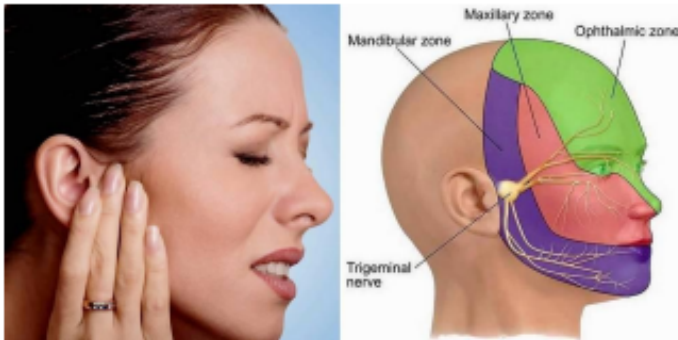
VSH News Letter

News | Views | Inspiration

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Trigeminal Neuralgia: Understanding a Life-Altering Pain Condition

Trigeminal neuralgia (TN) is a life-altering chronic pain condition that affects the trigeminal nerve, one of the major nerves in the face. This nerve is responsible for sensation in the face and controlling muscles used for chewing.



The hallmark of trigeminal neuralgia is intense, episodic pain. Key signs and symptoms include:

Severe Pain: The pain is often described as sharp, stabbing, or electric shock-like, usually affecting one side of the face

Triggers: Activities like talking, eating, brushing teeth, smiling, touching the face, wind hitting the face can provoke pain

Episodes: Pain episodes can last from a few seconds to a few minutes and may occur sporadically or in clusters.

Location: Pain typically affects specific areas of the face: such as the cheek, jaw, or around the eyes

Trigeminal neuralgia casts a shadow over the lives of both the patients and their loved ones, altering their world in profound ways:

Daily Life: The relentless, excruciating pain that spikes without warning transforms even the simplest joys into agonizing challenges. Everyday acts eating a meal, holding a conversation, or sharing a smile- can become overwhelming trials

Emotional Well-being: This ceaseless torment can drive individuals into a lonely corner, cutting them off from the warmth of social connections and might lead to stress, anxiety, and depression

Family Dynamics: The burden on caregivers and family members is immense, demanding both emotional fortitude and physical endurance. Their lives revolve around offering unwavering support, often at the cost of their own well-being

Managing trigeminal neuralgia often involves a blend of medical treatments, surgical techniques and lifestyle changes, with a growing emphasis on minimally invasive procedures designed to offer relief with fewer risks:

Medications: Typically, treatment begins with anticonvulsants like carbamazepine or oxcarbazepine to help control nerve pain. Additionally, medications such as gabapentin, pregabalin, lamotrigine, etc. might be prescribed to address various aspects of the condition

Minimally Invasive Procedures: For those who find little relief from medication alone, there are promising minimally invasive options such as balloon compression, radiofrequency ablation, and nerve blocks. Radiofrequency ablation of the trigeminal ganglion is a minimally invasive, day-care procedure that provides instantaneous pain relief with simplicity and precision. By using targeted radiofrequency energy to disrupt pain-transmitting nerve fibers, this technique allows patients to return home the same day, minimizing recovery time and avoiding the need for major surgery



Patient with trigeminal neuralgia undergoing RF ablation of trigeminal ganglion

Surgical options: Microvascular decompression and gamma knife radiosurgery, aim to provide lasting relief when medications have little effect or there is a secondary cause for trigeminal neuralgia

Lifestyle Adjustments: In conjunction with these treatments, managing triggers and stress through relaxation techniques or therapy can further help in easing symptoms and improving quality of life

If you or someone you know is experiencing symptoms of trigeminal neuralgia, it is important to consult with a healthcare provider to explore the most appropriate treatment options. Early intervention can significantly improve quality of life and help manage this challenging condition



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The Evolution of Neurorehabilitation: Shaping Recovery with Neuroplasticity

Introduction:

While the concept of rehabilitation is not new in India, the modern face of rehabilitation is being shaped by the principles of neuroplasticity, a new idea that is being increasingly accepted. There are only a handful of such modern rehabilitation centers that are well equipped with state of the arts instruments and teams of skilled speech, occupational and physical therapists that can be considered as centers of excellence.

Vydehi Superspeciality Hospital offers patients the latest rehabilitation technologies and equipment, to improve function, reduce muscle atrophy, and stimulate nerves. Recent advances in understanding of the connections between adaptive neuroplasticity and functional recovery have led to accelerated improvement in rehabilitation outcomes.

Our Aim at VSH is to:

1. To encourage and support multidisciplinary rehabilitation of people with cognitive, emotional, psychosocial and behavioural changes caused by brain injury or neurological conditions (both progressive and nonprogressive) across the lifespan.
2. To improve the care of survivors of brain injury and their families
3. To support the neuropsychological rehabilitation for patients and their families

Neurorehabilitation team consists of neurologists, neurosurgeons, physiatrists, rehabilitation nurses, working in neural regeneration and plasticity, and physical, occupational, and speech therapists aimed at functional recovery from neural injury and long term neurologic care.

Vsh neurorehabilitation program deals with the management and fundamental mechanisms of functional recovery from conditions such as stroke, multiple sclerosis, cerebral palsy, Parkinson's disease and other movement disorders, Alzheimer's disease and dementia, traumatic and acquired brain injuries and related secondary conditions, spinal cord injuries, and peripheral nerve injuries.

Interdisciplinary Treatment for Individualized Care

At VSH, neuro-rehabilitation is a true interdisciplinary program, with a team approach for providing individualized treatment designed to meet the needs of each patient. This close collaboration helps ensure coordination of care and convenience for families. It includes physical and occupational therapists, neuro-medicine and rehabilitation physicians, orthopedic surgeons, neurosurgeons, orthotists, and seating specialists.

CONCLUSION

Neurology & Neurorehabilitation at VSH aims to provide comprehensive and updated information pertaining to the neurological disorders to aid in efficient screening, accurate diagnosis, effective treatment and faster recovery while aiding in generating awareness among general public and health care professionals.



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Delivering Excellence in Critical Care: A Multifaceted Approach

A critically ill patient is one who has a life-threatening multisystem process that can result in significant morbidity and mortality. Effective, safe, and patient centric care is of paramount importance in the intensive care unit. We as clinicians, always tend to say and believe that we provide the best possible care to our critically ill patient. An Intensivist's dream is to have an ICU with state-of-the-art technology, infrastructure and an opportunity to deliver the highest quality of care by practices based on current evidence-based medicine.

In VSH we have a multi-disciplinary ICU managed 24/7 by team of clinicians from past one and half year, who are well trained in critical care and nursing staff who are well qualified and trained. we have 12 ICU beds and 1 isolation bed with negative suction. Our ICU is equipped with 8 functional high end ventilators, alpha beds and infusion pumps ,high end monitors with a transport monitor and portable ventilator. We provide facilities like dialysis including CRRT, ECMO,IABP in conjoint with the cardiology team.

We manage different cadres of patients like sepsis in shock, with multiorgan dysfunction, poisoning, road traffic accidents with polytrauma, obstetrics emergency, neurology and neurosurgical, vascular case, medicine and pulmonology cases including ARDS.

We carry out procedures like intubation, central venous cannulation, radial artery cannulation, dialysis catheter insertion, intercostal drainage tube, Abdominocentesis and thoracocentesis, percutaneous tracheostomy, lumbar puncture, bone marrow biopsy most of which is done under ultrasound guided as a standard of care. We care out bed side endoscopy of the Gastrointestinal Tract and also bronchoscopies.

Sepsis is being treated according to the recent guidelines from the Indian Society Of Critical Care, Infectious Disease Society Of America, Centre For Disease Control And Prevention.

Post surgical patients are managed with multimodal analgesia, and sedation of the ICU patients is according to the recent guidelines.

In order to harmonize a system of referrals and consultations, we will implement the concept of 'levels of care' and the 'triggers' for escalation of care.

The patient attenders will be updated about the diagnosis, day to day plan of treatment, progression of the condition of the patient, and the probable course in the ICU twice a day in an audio video counselling room.

These standardized measures make measurement of care easy and more importantly it leads to an objective comparison between units, within a hospital and between hospitals. The quality measures that are used across the world in ICU's stretch across the three main domains i.e., safe, efficient and patient care. The critical care units, the quality indicators most often used in the domain of safety include Unplanned extubation/Readmission to the ICU/Incidence of VAP/and other infections in the domain of efficiency we use ICU Length Of Stay, extubation failure rates, ICU mortality and other morbidities.



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Medical Terminology Challenge: Can You Unscramble These Words?

Funny thought: 

why did the skeleton go to the party alone?

Answer: Because it had no body to go with!

**Unscramble these jumbled words to reveal common
medical terms:**

TIICBOTIAN

OCSEPETTSOH

SSAIOIGDN

OIPCTERSRIPN

CNACVIE

GIBLEHONOM

PSEUL

MMTTERHREEO

MEIUNM

RNIASPI

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Now**

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Services

Foot & Ankle Services

Vascular Surgery /
Critical Limb Ischemia

Aesthetics

Ophthalmology /
Retinal Surgeries /
LASIK

Endocrinology

Nephrology

Pulmonology / Interventional Pulmonology

Neurology

Neurosurgery

OBG / High Risk
Pregnancy Center

Urology

Gastroenterology

Bariatric Surgery

Nephrology
Dialysis unit

Kidney, Liver, Lung &
Heart Transplant

Interventional
Radiology

Onco Surgery
Medical Oncology / IGRT

PICU & NICU

Orthodontics

Genetic Profiling

ENT / Cochlear Implants

Plastic Surgery

Maxillofacial Surgery

Bone Marrow Transplant

Advanced ICUs

Nutrition & Dietetics

Rheumatology

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Please send your suggestions and article contributions to your Co-ordinator



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